Bonjoo Gu

Ph.D. Candidate in Media and Communication
Hussman School of Journalism and Media
University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

bonjoo@unc.edu | bonjourgu.github.io | YouTube: Bonjoo's Nutshell

EDUCATION

2023–Present	**Ph.D. in Media and Communication, May 2027 (expected)** University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill Dissertation: "*How Does Asthma Status Shape Perceptions of Vaping and Responses to Vaping Prevention Messages?*"
2021	**M.A. in Mass Communication (Advertising & Public Relations)** Sogang University, Seoul, South Korea Thesis: "*Cancer Survivors on YouTube: Effects of Parasocial Contact on Reducing Prejudice toward Cancer Survivors*"
2019	**B.N. (Bachelor of Nursing)** Chung-Ang University, Seoul, South Korea

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Gu, B., Kramer, R. F., Kowitt, S. D., & Noar, S. M. (in press). Assessing the effectiveness of smoking and vaping prevention campaign videos: A meta-analysis. *Health Communication*.

Gu, B., Kowitt, S. D., Jang, Y., Tao, R., Li, K., Ritchie, C., Triana, V. E., Kim, M., Gottfredson O'Shea, N., & Noar, S. M. (2026). Characterizing the objective features of vaping prevention video ads: A content analysis. *American Journal of Preventive Medicine, 70*(5S), 108043. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.amepre.2025.108043

Lee, J. K., **Gu, B.**, Lee, M. J., Lee, H. J., & Yu, H. J. (2021). Factors affecting the intention to seek out mental health professionals: Focusing on public perception of mental health professionals, awareness, and previous counseling experience. *Health Communication Research, 20*(1), 37–74. https://doi.org/10.24172/hcr.2021.20.1.37

Yu, H. J., Kim, H. Y., Lee, S. C., Sung, Y., & **Gu, B.** (2020). An exploratory content analysis of the factors stimulating the use of new types of cigarettes in major social media: A case of YouTube. *Journal of Korean Society for Research on Nicotine and Tobacco, 11*(2), 35–47. https://doi.org/10.25055/JKSRNT.2020.11.2.35

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

Gu, B., Gottlieb, B., & Noar, S. M. Addressing content features and gaps in online childhood cancer survivorship materials for tobacco prevention: A content analysis. *PEC Innovation*. Revise & Resubmit.

Gu, B., & Lee, S. When language becomes a barrier: Communication, organization–public relationships, and behavioral intentions in U.S. healthcare.

Gu, B., Ranney, L. M., Jarman, K. L., Kowitt, S. D., Clark, S. A., Hash, C. L., Cornacchione Ross, J., Sheeran, P., Thrasher, J. F., Enyioha, C., & Goldstein, A. O. The impact of warning size and pictorial warnings on little cigar packaging: A factorial experiment.

Ranney, L. M.*, **Gu, B**.*, Jebai, R., Jetsupphasuk, M., Kowitt, S. D., Jarman, K. L., Clark, S. A., Goldstein, A. O., Thrasher, J. F., & Cornacchione Ross, J. Are blunt-specific messages perceived as effective? An experimental study among US youth and young adults.

*Co-first authors; contributed equally.

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

Gu, B., & Lee, S. A new layer of language support? How patients use digital translation and generative AI to navigate language-discordant care.

Gu, B., & Lee, S. Language support and organization–public relationships in U.S. healthcare.

Gottlieb, B., **Gu, B.**, Kowitt, S. D., & Noar, S. M. From field to screen: Content analysis of vaping prevention video advertisements.

Kowitt, S. D., Isaacson, E., Kramer, R. F., Tao, R., Jang, Y., **Gu, B**., Triana, V., Ritchie, C., Kim, M., Gottfredson O'Shea, N., & Noar, S. M. Identifying promising message features of vaping prevention video ads: An experiment with adolescents and young adults.

PEER-REVIEWED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Gu, B., & Lee, S. (2026, October 17). *When language becomes a barrier: Communication, organization–public relationships, and behavioral intentions in U.S. healthcare.* Oral presentation, 52nd Annual Conference of the Transcultural Nursing Society, San Antonio, TX.

Isaacson, E., Jang, Y., Kowitt, S. D., Tao, R., **Gu, B.**, Kramer, R. F., Triana, V., Ritchie, C., Kim, M., Gottfredson O'Shea, N., & Noar, S. M. (2026, July 22). *Do structural features of vaping prevention video ads elicit PMSV? An experiment with adolescents and young adults.* Oral presentation, 2026 Tobacco Regulatory Science Meeting, Bethesda, MD.

Gottlieb, B., **Gu, B.**, Kowitt, S. D., & Noar, S. M. (2026, July 22). *From field to screen: Content analysis of vaping prevention video advertisements.* Poster presentation, 2026 Tobacco Regulatory Science Meeting, Bethesda, MD.

Gu, B., Kramer, R. F., Kowitt, S. D., & Noar, S. M. (2026, July 22). *Assessing the effectiveness of smoking and vaping prevention campaign videos: A meta-analysis.* Poster presentation, 2026 Tobacco Regulatory Science Meeting, Bethesda, MD.

Kowitt, S. D., Isaacson, E., Kramer, R. F., Tao, R., Jang, Y., **Gu, B**., Triana, V., Ritchie, C., Kim, M., Gottfredson O'Shea, N., & Noar, S. M. (2026, July 22). *Identifying promising message features of vaping prevention video ads: An experiment with adolescents and young adults.* Oral presentation, Tobacco Regulatory Science Meeting, Bethesda, MD.

Gu, B., Kramer, R., Kowitt, S. D., & Noar, S. M. (2026, April 3). *Estimating the effectiveness of smoking and vaping prevention video advertisements: A meta-analysis.* Oral presentation, 2026 Kentucky Conference on Health Communication, Lexington, KY.

Gu, B., Gottlieb, B., & Noar, S. M. (2026, April 2). *Addressing content features and gaps in online*

childhood cancer survivorship materials for tobacco prevention: A content analysis. Poster presentation, 2026 Kentucky Conference on Health Communication, Lexington, KY.

Zhou, N., & **Gu, B.** (2025, June 13). *Beyond childhood: The impact of family literacy practices and subjective norms on lifelong reading habits.* Oral presentation, 75th Annual International Communication Association Conference, Denver, CO.

Gu, B., Kowitt, S. D., Jang, Y., Li, K., Ritchie, C., Triana, V. E., Kim, M., Gottfredson O'Shea, N., & Noar, S. M. (2024, October 17). *Characterizing the features of vaping prevention video ads: A content analysis.* Poster presentation, 2024 Tobacco Regulatory Science Meeting, Bethesda, MD.

Golden, S. D., Gougler-Reeves, K., **Gu, B**., Kowitt, S. D., Goldstein, A. O., & Ribisl, K. M. (2024, October 18). *Center-wide activities to address health equity in UNC TCORS.* Oral presentation, 2024 Tobacco Regulatory Science Meeting, Bethesda, MD.

Gu, B., & Yu, H. J. (2019, November 23). *Studying the effects of advertisements promoting chronic disease management.* Oral presentation, Annual Fall Convention of Korean Association of AD & PR, Ansan, Korea.

Yu, H. J., & **Gu, B.** (2019, October 12). *Different perspectives on public PR: Comparing policy consumers, practitioners, and related professionals.* Oral presentation, Annual Fall Convention of Korea Advertising Society, Cheongju, Korea.

GRANT EXPERIENCE

2025–Present **Principal Investigator**

Estimating the Effectiveness of Smoking and Vaping Prevention Videos: A Meta-Analysis.

National Institute on Drug Abuse (NIDA)/FDA Center for Tobacco Products (CTP) | Pilot grant under 1U54DA060049-01 | $7,950

- Developed the grant proposal, secured pilot funding, and led the meta-analysis from study design through manuscript preparation.
- Serve on the dissemination committee, helping communicate research findings to broader audiences through videos and other outreach materials.

2023–Present **Graduate Research Assistant and Predoctoral Trainee**

Advancing Tobacco Regulatory Science to Reduce Health Disparities–Project 4: Understanding the Prevention Ads on Adolescents and Young Adults.

NIDA/FDA CTP | 1U54DA060049-01 (PI: Kurt M. Ribisl) | $3.5M (Project 4)

- Led Aim 1 content analysis and manuscript development, conducted Aim 2 experimental analyses, contributed to Aim 3 RCT design, led manuscripts with junior graduate researchers, and reviewed center pilot grant proposals.

2025 **Graduate Research Assistant**

Little Cigar and Cigarillo Warnings to Reduce Tobacco-Related Cancers and Disease.

National Cancer Institute/FDA | 5R01CA240732-05 (PI: Adam O. Goldstein) |

$2.7M

- Led two manuscripts and contributed to a third examining little cigar warnings, blunt-specific health risk messaging, and package descriptors.

2023–2024 **Graduate Research Assistant**

Impact of E-Cigarette Prevention Messages on Adolescents.

National Institutes of Health (NIH) | 5R01DA049155-02 (PI: Seth M. Noar) | $687K

- Contributed to the development and pilot testing of an adolescent e-cigarette prevention text message intervention, including intervention refinement, survey measures, and study implementation.

2019–2020 **Graduate Research Assistant**

Analyzing the Current State of New Types of Cigarette Marketing and Proposing Governmental Countermeasures.

Ministry of Health and Welfare in Korea | $65K

- Led social media content analysis and think-aloud experiments; contributed to survey studies, project administration, research reports, and government presentations.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

Fall 2025 *MEJO 379 Advertising & Public Relations Research*

- Enrollment: 25 undergraduate students
- Designed and taught an undergraduate research methods course covering surveys, experiments, content analysis, and data analysis.

Teaching Assistant, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

Fall 2026 *MEJO 890 Meta-Analysis*

- Led applied sessions on meta-analysis methods and Comprehensive Meta-Analysis software and facilitated hands-on research workshops.

Teaching Assistant, Sogang University

Spring 2020 *Marketing Communication; Advertisement and Design Plans*

- Produced recorded lectures, managed synchronous Zoom sessions, and prepared instructional materials.

Spring & Fall 2019 *Creativity & Visual Expression; Health Communication*

- Assisted with course preparation, instructional materials, and course activities.

INVITED TALKS AND GUEST LECTURES

Oct 2026 *Nurses as Message Creators: Lessons from Vaping Prevention Campaigns.* Doctor

	of Nursing Practice Immersion Day, School of Nursing, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill.
Apr 2026	*When language becomes a barrier: Communication, organization–public relationships, and behavioral intentions in U.S. healthcare.* 2026 Spring Graduate Research Colloquium, Hussman School of Journalism and Media, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill.
Feb 2026	*Vaping prevention video ads and communication strategies.* AH4030 Public Health Communication. Department of Allied Health Sciences, University of Connecticut.
Oct 2025	*Addressing content features and gaps in online childhood survivorship materials for tobacco prevention.* UNC Adolescent and Young Adult Research Working Group. Lineberger Comprehensive Cancer Center.

HONORS & AWARDS

May 2026	Diversity and Inclusion Career Development Fellow, Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication
Apr 2026	Top Six Honorable Mention Poster Award, 2026 Kentucky Conference on Health Communication
Sep 2025	Student Scholarship, North Carolina Korean Nurses Association
Apr 2020	GS SHOP Content Leader Scholarship, GS SHOP
Dec 2019	Foreign Students Mentoring Scholarship, Sogang University
Oct 2016	Top Content Creator Award, Korea Disease Control and Prevention Agency

SERVICE

Institutional Service

Oct 2026–Present **Dean's Student Advisory Committee Member**, Hussman School of Journalism and Media

- Provide feedback to the dean on school policies, programs, resources, curriculum, and student experience.

Sep 2024–Present **Founder & Leader**, International Graduate Student Support Group, Hussman School of Journalism and Media

- Founded and currently lead a peer support group for international graduate students, including monthly meetings and student support activities.

Jan 2024–Present **International Media Committee**, Hussman School of Journalism and Media

- Supported career development and networking initiatives connecting international undergraduates with faculty, staff, and alumni.

Feb 2026 Research Showcase Panelist. *Meta-analysis on the effectiveness of vaping prevention ads.* UNC Hussman School of Journalism and Media.

Feb 2025 Graduate Student Panelist, Admitted Student Visit. UNC Hussman School of

Journalism and Media.

Dec 2019–Jul 2020 **International Student Mentor**, Sogang University

- Mentored international graduate students, providing language, academic, and administrative support.

Mar 2016–Dec 2016 **Korean Language Assistant**, Chung-Ang University

- Provided Korean language and academic support to international students.

Journal and Conference Reviewer

- Health Communication
- Substance Use and Misuse
- International Communication Association (ICA) Annual Conference

ACADEMIC AND PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication
- Transcultural Nursing Society
- North Carolina Korean Nurses Association

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Oct 2021–Sep 2022 **Charge Nurse**, Cancer Survivor Center, National Cancer Center

- Provided individualized survivorship counseling and communicated treatment summaries and care plans to 110+ childhood cancer survivors.

Oct 2020–Feb 2021 **Assistant School Nurse**, Sanggye Middle School

- Implemented COVID-19 prevention protocols and provided health assessment, first aid, medication administration, and health guidance to students.

Mar–Oct 2019 **Health Counseling Nurse**, Gangnam & Gangbuk Community Health Centers

- Conducted 3,000+ mobile health app-supported counseling sessions for adults with metabolic syndrome, focusing on health behavior change.

LICENSURE & PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

2021–Present	Registered Nurse in the State of New York
2019–Present	Registered Nurse in Korea
2022	Smoking Cessation Counseling Expert Training Course
2021–2022	Cancer Survivorship Expert Training Course

COMMUNITY-ENGAGED PROJECTS

Dec 2017–Jan 2018 HEALNESIA Project, Yogyakarta, Indonesia

- Planned and delivered community-based smoking prevention campaigns in collaboration with a local university, developing educational materials and conducting outreach at schools, children's homes, and local neighborhoods.

Jun–Aug 2015 Viver com Dignidade, Teresina, Brazil

- Conducted community outreach and fundraising for a local NGO through in-person campaigns and social media, creating digital content to raise awareness of the organization and its programs.

RESEARCH METHODS & SOFTWARE

Methods: Content analysis, meta-analysis, experiments, surveys, interviews, computational text analysis

Quantitative: R, SPSS, Comprehensive Meta-Analysis (CMA)

Qualitative: NVivo